

Stone Center on Socio-Economic Inequality

Seeking 1 Research Assistant

Apply by December 6, 2024

Supervisor

Maximilian Longmuir, Postdoctoral Scholar, the Stone Center on Socio-Economic Inequality, CUNY Graduate Center

Project title

Wealth accumulation and mobility in the United States

Project summary

Dr. Max Longmuir is seeking a research assistant to support a project on wealth accumulation and mobility in the United States. The RA will be responsible for compiling and managing data from the Panel Study of Income Dynamics (PSID), focusing on wealth, consumption, and other socio-economic modules. This role involves preparing datasets for use in various research projects, including studies on intergenerational mobility and saving behavior over time. The position offers the opportunity for the research assistant to develop their own research ideas and contribute to the ongoing projects within a team. Ideal candidates will have strong data management skills, attention to detail, and an interest in economic research.

Job description

- Collect, clean, and harmonize data from the PSID, focusing on wealth, consumption, and other socio-economic modules. Ensure the data is well-structured and accurate, ready for use in a range of research projects related to wealth accumulation and mobility.
- Prepare datasets for empirical analysis, including creating summary statistics, visualizations, and preliminary analysis. Support the team by checking robustness, and documenting results.
- Review existing academic literature related to wealth accumulation, saving behavior, and intergenerational mobility. Summarize key findings and identify gaps in the literature that can inform ongoing and future research projects.

- Participate in meetings with the research team (which includes Postdoctoral Scholar Severin Rapp) to develop and refine empirical strategies. Offer insights and suggestions on data management practices, coding, and the design of analysis frameworks.
- Engage with the project team to develop research ideas related to wealth, savings, and economic mobility. Access to the PSID and mentorship will be provided to help the RA advance their research agenda and co-author papers when applicable.

Desired qualifications

- Ph.D. student in economics, sociology, political science, or related disciplines.
- Understanding of, and experience in, applied statistics/econometrics.
- Advanced quantitative/methodological skills and experience working with Stata and/or R.
- Previous knowledge of working with the PSID (valued but not mandatory).
- Strong writing skills.

Terms

- The initial employment appointment is from February 1, 2025, to May 31, 2025, with the possibility of extending the appointment into the following academic year.
- The hourly rate for this position is \$32.00 per hour.
- The expected hours for this position are 12 hours per week. All aspects related to timing will be agreed upon between the research assistant and the supervisor before the work starts.
- The research assistant will be hired through the Research Foundation of the City of New York (RF CUNY) as a Part-Time B employee, under the contract title “Research Aide.” Part-Time B employees are eligible to accrue time-off and for collective bargaining.

How to apply

- Send CV and a cover letter describing relevant experience.
- Send all materials to Maximilian Longmuir at mlongmuir@gc.cuny.edu.
- Materials should be submitted via email by **December 6, 2024**.
- Applications will be reviewed until the position is filled.